71 I can use common adverbs

A Emphasis

only	We use **only** to say 'no more than'. *She was **only** 17 when she got married.* (It's unusual to get married at 17.) *We can walk to the station – it's **only** five minutes.* (Not 15 or 20.)
even	We often use **even** before a fact that is surprising or difficult to believe. *It's cold here, **even** in summer.* (In most places, it's warm in the summer.) *My older brother is 1.90m, and my younger brother is **even** taller.*
still	We use **still** to say that a fact or situation continues to be true. *After 25 years, I **still** love my job.* (I continue to love my job.) *Do they live in Paris now? ~ No, they're **still** in London.*
especially (also **particularly**)	We use **especially** to say 'more than others' or 'more than usual'. *We liked the towns in the south, **especially** Seville.* (Seville was the best.) *It's very hot here, **especially** in July and August.* (July and August are the hottest.)

1 Put the word in brackets in the correct place in the sentence.

▶ It's six kilometres to the next town. (only) It's only six kilometres to the next town.

1 He's 75 and he plays tennis. (still) _____

2 It's nice there, in the morning. (especially) _____

3 There are three students in the class. (only) _____

4 He works on Sundays. (even) _____

5 She's at university. (still) _____

6 Rio is big, but São Paolo is bigger. (even) _____

2 Circle the correct answer.

▶ The food is good there, only/especially the fish.

1 He was only/even 15 when he left school.

2 I've seen the film five times and I even/still enjoy it.

3 The students are very nice, still/particularly Marcel.

4 There are even/only three bridges like this in the world.

5 It was cold yesterday but it's even/still colder today.

6 I study hard but my English is still/only terrible.

Write the new words in your own sentences. Say them to yourself.

3 Complete the sentences.

▶ He's ninety, but he still drives a car.

1 _____ four people came to the party; it was a bit sad.

2 They've been in Hong Kong for ten years and they _____ like living there.

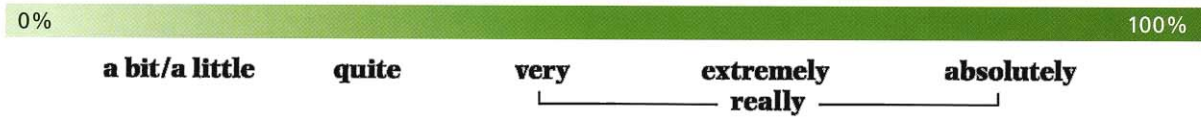
3 I love fish, _____ salmon.

4 He can't drive; he's _____ 15.

5 Jacqui's thin, but her sister is _____ thinner.

6 She enjoyed the book, _____ the first part.

B Degree



a bit/a little	Use **a bit** or **a little** before an adjective or comparative adjective, but not before a positive adjective. (NOT ~~a bit good~~) *The lesson was **a bit** boring. It's **a little** warmer than yesterday.*
quite	= more than *a bit*, but less than *very* *The film was **quite** interesting. The town is **quite** big.*
extremely	= a bit stronger than *very* Use **extremely** before gradable adjectives (see spotlight). *I was **extremely** tired by 6 o'clock. We were **extremely** busy on Saturday.*
absolutely	Use **absolutely** before ungradable adjectives (see spotlight) for emphasis. *The food was **absolutely** delicious. The party was **absolutely** fantastic.*
really	= *very, extremely* or *absolutely* You can use **really** with gradable and ungradable adjectives, and with verbs. *The restaurant was **really** good. The weather was **really** terrible.* *We were **really** tired. **I really** liked the film.*

4 **Circle the correct answer.**
Sometimes both answers are correct.

- ▶ It was quite/a bit interesting.
- ▶ This programme is really/absolutely terrible.
1. The weather was very/absolutely nice.
2. Her new shoes are very/absolutely wonderful.
3. My sister is a bit/a little untidy.
4. I really/extremely want to go to Australia.
5. She was really/extremely friendly.
6. Their flat is a bit/quite nice.
7. The hotel was very/really good.
8. The boat is extremely/really enormous.

spotlight **Gradable and ungradable adjectives**

Gradable adjectives, e.g. *good, big, bad, nice, boring, young, tired, busy*
Ungradable adjectives, e.g. *awful, perfect, terrible, wonderful, delicious, fantastic* (= very, very good), *enormous* (= very, very big)

5 **Rewrite the sentences. Use an adverb with a similar meaning to the underlined word(s).**

- ▶ The film was a bit boring. The film was a little boring.
- ▶ The children were really fantastic. The children were absolutely fantastic.
1. He was very good. _____
2. The holiday was absolutely wonderful. _____
3. She's a little unfriendly. _____
4. The kitchen was extremely clean. _____
5. The room was a bit small. _____
6. Her new boyfriend is really awful. _____
7. They're really nice people. _____
8. The weather was absolutely terrible. _____